



The War in Sudan and Its Repercussions for Regional Security in Africa

*Achacha kenza**
guelma University Algeria
achacha.kenza@univ-guelma.dz

Rafik.boubchiche
Banta 1 University Algeria
rafik.boubchiche@univ-batna.dz

Abstract

The War in Sudan threatens regional security in Africa through armed groups, civil-military tensions, and weakened state capabilities. These challenges increase vulnerabilities for neighboring nations, highlighting the need for enhanced cross-border cooperation and support for the African Union's Peace and Security framework. As the conflict escalates, armed groups cross borders, raising security risks. Deteriorating security structures in Sudan create governance vacuums and reignite historical border tensions, leading to local conflicts. Additionally, the influx of Sudanese refugees further complicates regional security, intensifying civil-military discord.

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* Corresponding author

1. Introduction

Two decades of peace precede four years of war in Sudan. That war—and the regional and global fallout it has spawned—demonstrates that proximate events matter as much as distant causes in shaping regional relations and structures. Even in the ostensibly distant Horn of Africa, the weekend-scene-climax-strita-wild welcomes events moving diplomatic relationships southward, offering credible hope of addressing the chronic instability and the civil war that has ripped the country apart since late 2021. As actors in the broader Trans Sahara region scramble to fill the vacuum, the risk of further destabilization rises by the day. Events have built energy for diplomacy, but a common strategy remains dormant. The Sudan War clearly reveals that, when it comes to preparing and responding to regional security challenges, Africa still lacks an effective, interrelated set of media, mechanisms, and policies.

The Sudanese conflict also reveals that regional institutions still have a long way to go before they can speak with a credible collective voice. Three years of civil war in the Central African Republic and growing threats in Chad, Eritrea, Libya, Niger, and outside the region Further underline the need to ramp up technical and political support to the African Union—both for the continental body as a whole and for the coordination of Africa's response to security crises in the Trans Sahara The region still needs a effective Mediac Center capable of directing Security Governance beyond answering external demands for support. The progressive establishment and operation of a Security Governance Group and related specialist Red or teams should be a priority investment in the speed of the new Wind of Diplomacy blowing in the Horn of Africa.

Research question: How does the ongoing war in Sudan affect regional security in Africa?

1. Historical background of Sudanese conflicts

Sudan has produced an exceptionally vast and diverse number of scholarly analyses that delve deeply into its multifaceted historical evolution. This exploration particularly focuses on the underlying conflicts that have been progressively taking shape since the time of the Anglo-Egyptian occupation, a period that has left indelible marks on the country's sociopolitical landscape. Some of the fundamental causes behind these protracted and persistent conflicts have already been thoroughly explored in an array of other academic works, providing a solid foundation for understanding the current situation in Sudan. Therefore, a useful and comprehensive summary of the roots of the ongoing upheaval, along with their profound implications for the war dynamics that are currently at play, is accordingly provided, drawing on a wide array of literature and diverse perspectives. (Alamin et al.2024)

The importance of undertaking a thorough historical background analysis cannot be overstated, particularly when considering the complexity and the depth of Sudan's past. Given the repeated cycles of violent upheaval, the subsequent peace negotiations, and the various peace agreements that have emerged over the years, it is entirely understandable that the expected scholarly attention tends to be directed mainly toward periods of war as well as the immediate factors of pressing concern that arise during those turbulent times. This tendency often results in a more reactive approach to scholarship, focusing predominantly on crises rather than preventative measures and long-term solutions. The recent direct causes and specific triggers that are driving the latest outbreak of

hostilities in Sudan are therefore examined in detail, separated from earlier historical narratives to highlight their unique context and implications. In the following sections, these factors will be discussed in detail to provide a clearer understanding of the complex web of influences that contribute to the ongoing conflict. (Aderinto and Olatunji, 2023)

A significant and multifaceted political and military crisis currently envelops the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF), and this has acted as a powerful catalyst for the widespread conflict that is deeply impacting the nation as a whole. This multifaceted crisis finds its roots in a variety of surrounding factors, which collectively comprise a range of long-standing grievances among diverse groups within the country, as well as a profound and deep-seated resentment that can be traced back to the complex history and intricate processes that constitute the very fabric of the Sudanese state itself. One critical element worth considering in this context is the policy of predation that has long masqueraded as an effective means of state control over the national economy. This predatory approach has led to widespread disenchantment and dissatisfaction among the populace, fueling anger and unrest.

Furthermore, this already complex situation is further complicated by the dual functions and multifaceted roles of the Rapid Support Forces (RSF), a powerful paramilitary group that has wielded significant influence over internal security and governance in the country. These dynamics are compounded by the staggering levels of youth unemployment, which are alarmingly coupled with a troublingly high standard of military training among the younger demographic. This combination creates a dangerously volatile environment that is all too ripe for conflict and social upheaval. (Drent et al.2022)

The absence of inclusive and effective

governance mechanisms, which are essential for addressing the numerous internal grievances that have accumulated over years of neglect, has also exacerbated the ongoing crisis. This neglect has left many segments of the population feeling disenfranchised, unheard, and marginalized, thus intensifying their frustrations. In addition to these pressing internal issues, external factors such as the protracted conflict in the neighboring Tigray region of Ethiopia and the ongoing instability in Libya have further strained the situation in Sudan, influencing the dynamics at play and adding layers of complexity to an already tense scenario.

The structure of incentives that has been established and maintained over the course of more than three decades of military rule exercised by the National Congress Party National Islamic Front (NCP-NIF) has emerged as a central and significant cause of the widespread discontent. This entrenched structure has functioned as a relentless push towards favoritism, pervasive corruption, and various abuses of power. Additionally, it has led to the manipulation of political, economic, and military resources for personal gain—all at the direct expense of collective national objectives. In doing so, this pervasive situation has severely undermined any hope for a cohesive, stable, and peaceful future for the Sudanese people, further fueling the cycle of conflict and instability that continues to plague this nation. (Arafat2025)

2. Causative factors of the current war and triggering events

The causes of the ongoing war in Sudan can be traced back to both political and economic factors that have evolved over time. During the final years under the oppressive al-Bashir dictatorship, the regime utilized paramilitary forces to strengthen its control over the state, while simultaneously engaging in the trade of gold to acquire hard currency that the economy

so desperately needed. However, the consequent rise in strength of the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) began to pose a significant threat to the traditional armed forces of Sudan, leading to fierce rivalries between the two groups. This competition was further escalated by varying regional alliances and interests, which served to undermine any attempts at meaningful diplomacy between the conflicting parties. When General al-Burhan attempted to incorporate the RSF into the regular army, he faced a swift rejection from Hemedti, the leader of the RSF, who consequently began to prepare for warfare instead. Tensions boiled over in April 2023 when fighting erupted, quickly spreading from Khartoum and igniting intercommunal clashes that involved other significant players, such as the Sudan People's Liberation Movement-North (SPLM-N), the Beja Council, and the Sudan Liberation Army. The repercussions of this conflict have been devastating, resulting in the displacement of approximately half of the country's population, which numbers around 46 million individuals, leaving over two million people seeking refuge in neighboring countries. Unfortunately, attempts to establish humanitarian corridors to alleviate the suffering of those affected have failed miserably. Initial pledges of assistance and support from organizations like the African Union, IGAD, and the United Nations have not resulted in any serious proposals or solutions from either the African Union or IGAD. (Hassan et al.2025)

The civil war that erupted dramatically in April 2023 between the Sudan Armed Forces (SAF), which is under the command of General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan, and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF), led by the influential figure Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo, widely known as Hemedti, marked a notably significant and intense point in a protracted power struggle that has been simmering within the Sudanese military leadership for a considerable duration.

This deeply embedded rivalry was not a sudden occurrence; rather, it was the culmination of a series of political and military maneuvers, divisions, and conflicts surrounding the quest for control and influence within both government and civilian sectors. The earlier Sudanese spring of 2018-19 was ignited not only by the deteriorating economic conditions in the country but also by severe state repression that escalated tensions further. This situation was exacerbated by the global ramifications of the COVID-19 pandemic, which heavily impacted both the economy and public health systems. When the al-Bashir regime, notorious for its authoritarian and oppressive rule, collapsed in April 2019, a new chapter began in Sudan's history; however, the subsequent military-led ruling council that was formed in the aftermath sought to undermine the crucial partnership with civilian forces that had played an essential role in facilitating its rise to power. Despite the initial hopes for much-needed democratic reform and stability, the prospects for a rapid recovery of the economy through external assistance and loans, which had initially sparked a glimmer of optimism, virtually evaporated. This collapse revealed the profound fragility of the state and laid bare the weak nature of its leadership amidst the ongoing internal and external tensions.. (Ahmed et al.2025)

3. Direct security implications for Sudan and neighboring states

The ongoing war in Sudan significantly impacts regional security in a multitude of complex and multifaceted ways, some of which are widely recognized and acknowledged by both analysts and experts in the field. However, it is crucial to highlight that, at this juncture, there is currently no broad consensus on the exact implications of the war for the neighboring countries that find themselves involved in this precarious situation. For the three immediate neighboring countries—South Sudan, the Central African

Republic, and Chad—the calculus is clearly and unambiguously negative. It would be quite surprising and indeed quite concerning if the countries of East Africa did not also view the evolving developments in Sudan with a growing sense of unease and apprehension that could alter their strategic calculations. Sudan is recognized as a nation of considerable size and strategic importance within the region, bolstered by a military force that remains largely intact and capable. This ongoing conflict is troubling not just for Sudan but raises serious concerns that extend far beyond its borders. Additionally, Sudan is a nation deeply divided along various lines, with a relatively large number of independent political groups vying for power and influence. These groups are interconnected through well-established horizontal networks and are actively pursuing their own diverse and often conflicting political agendas. If history serves as a guide, these factions are more likely than not to be very eager to seek foreign support in their endeavors, which can complicate regional stability further and lead to unforeseen consequences for all involved. The potential for spillover effects into bordering nations is particularly alarming, given the existing tensions and fragile political situations in these countries. The dynamics of such a conflict, characterized by shifting alliances and power struggles, could easily exacerbate already existing vulnerabilities, leading to a more volatile and uncertain future for the entire region. (Liyew, 2025)

Direct security implications for Sudan and its neighboring states can thus be understood at two significant and distinct levels. The first level pertains specifically to the nations that are situated in close proximity to Sudan, where the ongoing and escalating war is generating immediate and direct threats, particularly in the context of spillover effects that are becoming more pronounced. These effects are characterized by the potential influx of

refugees seeking safety, cross-border violence stemming from the conflict, and the destabilization of local governance structures in the affected neighboring countries. The responsiveness of these nations is crucial as they grapple with these mounting challenges and contemplate their next moves in terms of national security strategy and humanitarian assistance for those in dire need. The regional governments must navigate this complex landscape to ensure safety and support for vulnerable populations, being mindful of their own national interests amid the turmoil. (Çinar and Özer, 2023)

The second level of concern connects to the broader diplomatic and political security ramifications that irreversibly arise from the war in Sudan, which have profound implications for the countries in East Africa, the wider IGAD region, as well as the African Standby Force (AFSF), which may find itself under increased pressure to respond effectively. In times of conflict, borders assume integral importance for maintaining security, and wartime efforts in terms of border patrol and enforcement are frequently stretched and pushed to their limits, creating significant partnerships and strains alike. As a conflict escalates further, the dynamics of border management and security enforcement necessitate an increasingly delicate balancing act that countries must navigate carefully. Such a volatile situation could potentially degenerate into a complete collapse of order or an aggressive militarization of border zones, substantially raising tensions and complicating the already fragile peace and security landscape in the region. The interplay of these factors underscored by local and regional governance challenges will determine how effectively the neighboring countries can manage the fallout from such a devastating war.

4.1. Territorial integrity and border dynamics

A deteriorating and increasingly volatile security environment in Sudan has raised substantial fears regarding its overall territorial integrity and stability. The situation has become alarmingly precarious, eliciting concerns not only from local actors but also from external observers monitoring the dynamics in the region. Spillover effects from this chaos are being profoundly felt in neighboring states, which have implemented a diverse array of coping strategies in response to the ensuing turmoil and disorder. While some nations along the borders appear particularly vulnerable to incursions, raids, and insurgent infiltration from Sudan, others have proactively adopted robust containment and deterrence strategies aimed at safeguarding their borders and maintaining internal security. (Verhoeven, 2023)

Internally displaced Sudanese individuals and families, numbering in the millions, require urgent sanctuary in various neighboring states and potentially even beyond, thus creating significant and pressing humanitarian challenges that need immediate attention and coordinated international response. The risk of experiencing protracted insecurity vacuums prevails even in the absence of direct and conventional attacks on a neighboring state's territory. Armed groups operating in adjacent conflict zones often establish intricate informal rules that govern territorial use and distinctive labor mobility between host and contributing communities. Such cooperation and understanding between these disparate groups can quickly dissolve and turn into conflict, especially in regions where political regimes lack legitimacy and public trust. Should the delicate balance of territorial integrity falter under such strains, it is likely that further escalation and deterioration will occur rapidly and unexpectedly, leading to even more

complex regional instability, which could necessitate urgent diplomatic interventions and enhanced security measures across borders.

The danger faced by the Central African Republic and Chad is particularly acute, as national borders in these regions have frequently been violated or undermined due to various incursions or calculated attempts aimed at destabilizing the very core of their governments. These actions create immediate threats to the stability and security of these nations, but they also carry long-term implications that can severely impact regional stability over time. However, it appears that a Sudanese army, which is operationally capable, plays a critical role in entrenching either strategy within the volatile Darfur region, a zone that has long been characterized by recurrent turmoil and persistent unrest. The precariousness of the situation is exacerbated by the existence of fragile dynamics along other key trajectory segments, such as the legitimacy of the government and local support for controlling actors. These dynamics lead to significant spillover concerns for neighboring countries such as Egypt and Ethiopia, both of which are increasingly wary of the broader implications of Sudan's instability. With the escalating violence and insurgency in Sudan threatening to disrupt any externally imposed order that has previously arisen from past interventions or diplomatic arrangements, the ramifications of these developments become increasingly troubling. This situation can complicate future access to essential humanitarian assistance, which could potentially become entangled in the complex web of internal power struggles that characterize the region. Moreover, with a larger flow of displaced individuals moving across designated corridors to escape the turmoil, there exists a genuine risk that this chaotic situation could impose an overwhelming security burden on the very few states that are willing to accept and provide

refuge to the majority of asylum seekers fleeing the chaos and violence. (Karomba et al.)

4.2. Displacement, humanitarian access, and refugee flows

The United Nations estimates that the ongoing and brutal fighting in Sudan has forcibly displaced approximately 1.9 million individuals, leading to a humanitarian crisis of unprecedented proportions. At the same time, this conflict has triggered a significant exodus of over 730,000 refugees as they flee to nearby neighboring countries in search of safety and stability. The situation is dire, and many of these individuals face substantial risks, including becoming potential targets of xenophobic violence and hostility amid such widespread states of mass displacement in this increasingly volatile region. The various parties involved in this prolonged conflict, along with their respective partners, have publicly expressed their desires to facilitate access to crucial humanitarian assistance for those suffering and in dire need of such support. However, the actual distribution and delivery of humanitarian aid remain contentious subjects that are, indeed, up for ongoing debate among the various stakeholders involved in this crisis. Although the United Nations and various international aid agencies are actively calling for the establishment of humanitarian corridors designed to ensure that essential aid reaches those who require it the most urgently, it has consistently proven to be exceedingly challenging to get shipments through to the predetermined destinations without delay. This challenge is typically due to two primary and interrelated issues: insufficient funding, which significantly hampers the ability to transport vital resources effectively and safely, and a considerable lack of guarantees for the safe passage of aid convoys, which heightens the dangers faced by those individuals and organizations trying to deliver aid in a safe

manner. The complexities of the situation are exacerbated by political gridlock and the ongoing fighting, which hinders progress at every turn. (Vincent and Mgaya, 2022)

Despite the globally hailed humanitarian efforts made by various countries and organizations to provide assistance, the majority of refugees continue to remain unprotected and in dire situations that are worsening by the day. The 1967 Additional Protocol to the 1951 Refugee Convention does indeed offer a partial solution to some extent by calling for the establishment of a Co-ordination Committee that would assist in managing and addressing refugee issues comprehensively. However, unfortunately, the crucial Non-Refoulement principle designed to protect refugees from being returned to places where their lives or freedom would be threatened is repeatedly violated in practice. This often leads to perilous conditions for those seeking safety, as many individuals and families are sent back to danger rather than receiving the protection they desperately need. Moreover, asylum countries, under various pretexts, frequently refuse to host new refugees, turning a blind eye to the humanitarian crisis unfolding before them and ignoring their obligations under international law. Even in the challenging case of Sudanese refugees fleeing to South Sudan, they initially found some semblance of relative peace and security in their new surroundings. However, over time, they began to face increasing threats and a multitude of challenges, often exacerbated by overlapping local conflicts that continue to rage and the unpreparedness of South Sudan to absorb a new influx of refugees at all levels, from housing to essential services, which has created a precarious and uncertain situation for all those involved. (Grippio, 2025)

4.3. Civil-military actors and governance vacuums

The ongoing and devastating war in Sudan is creating significant governance vacuums and dramatically increasing the fragility within the security sector, which consequently and negatively impacts the overall stability of Sudan and deeply affects security relations among its neighbouring states. The existing leadership split within the army, accompanied by the prominent and influential role of a paramilitary force that has developed its own independent bases of power, exacerbates these complex evolutions and challenges. Furthermore, the notable absence of strong, effective, and resilient state institutions is raising serious security concerns not just in the immediate region, but also well beyond it, echoing through various geopolitical landscapes. The intense and ongoing battle over both Sudanese power dynamics and critical resources is shaping how various external actors perceive the sensitive border areas, the associated risks, and the possible mitigating measures they may consider. This precarious situation creates a dangerous cycle of instability that threatens both local and regional security, leading to uncertainty and potential escalation. The interplay of these factors underscores the complexity of the situation, making resolution all the more challenging in a landscape marked by turmoil and strife. (Verhoeven, 2023)

As is the case in various parts of the region, the provision of security and the maintenance of political stability are increasingly being undermined due to ongoing disputes and a troubling absence of credible and legitimate governance frameworks. This concerning scenario is the result of a multitude of factors that have contributed to a complex socio-political landscape. The longstanding inability to bridge divides and integrate other communities into the security sector only serves to strengthen the appeal of armed

opposition groups. This, in turn, incites insurrection by those who feel increasingly excluded from both the political process and the security measures being established. While control of the capital may very well shift to another party or faction in the near future, it remains crucial to recognize that security relations among the Sudanese people, as well as those with neighboring countries, will likely remain incredibly frail, volatile, and unstable in the longer term. This instability not only affects internal dynamics but also has ramifications that extend beyond the country's borders. External actors, particularly those within the regional community, are therefore facing mounting pressure to take proactive and well-coordinated measures to bolster, strengthen, and reinforce security structures and essential functions that are critical for achieving and maintaining a sustainable stability in the region. The need for collaborative efforts and a unified approach has never been more urgent, as the risks of further escalation and conflict loom large in the background. (Çinar and Özer, 2023)

5. Policy options for regional stability and Africa-wide resilience

The comprehensive analysis conducted highlights several critical priority policy options that could play a significant role in effectively assisting in mitigating not only the immediate but also the far-reaching implications of the ongoing Sudan War for overall regional stability. These well-considered policy options may prove to be quite effective in significantly reducing the potential risk of war-induced reverberations that could negatively affect the broader African security environment in various ways and forms. It is essential to acknowledge and underline that, especially in light of the response to past incidents characterized by the spillovers of war and conflict, even relatively low-key initiatives and regionally coordinated efforts aimed specifically at limiting security

management vacuums in the neighboring states of Sudan could indeed play a crucial role in stabilizing the overall situation. Such collaborative efforts and concerted initiatives may meaningfully reduce the adverse security impacts that are brought about by the ongoing conflict and its aftermath while ultimately contributing to a more stable and secure regional outlook. The importance of such measures and interventions cannot be overstated, as they hold the significant potential to enhance cooperation among neighboring countries and foster a more resilient and capable security framework in response to the multifaceted challenges arising from the conflict and its profound implications for the region. (Babalola and Akinrinde, 2024)

The first option is tailored around border management and control. Although weak borders have previously welcomed uncontrolled arms flows into Sudan, served as conduits for cross-border aggression by armed non-state actors, and enabled illicit trade — activities that have contributed to, rather than countered, insecurity in either direction — enhanced management and control of these borders can reduce the immediate risk of conflict spillover and broader regional destabilization. Creating effective border management systems requires sustained effort by Sudan's neighbors, individually and collectively; such investments are approximate priorities. Within each national context, they entail upgrading cooperation between the border police and customs services, strengthening training of the border police and customs services, ensuring effective day-to-day communications and interoperability between the two services, sharing intelligence and security information at multiple levels, enhancing legal and resource capacities to prosecute and curb illegal trade more effectively, making border security a greater focus of national policymaking, and developing contingency plans for coordinating

responses to emerging security risks. However, alone these measures are insufficient. Addressing the capacity deficiencies of the national security and law-enforcement agencies is also key, especially in countries neighboring Sudan. Although the international community has provided substantive training and logistical support for the police and border services, these efforts need to gather greater momentum. (Nzai, 2024)

5.1. Strengthening border management and security sector reform

To effectively mitigate the significant risk of further deterioration in Sudan and across the wider region, it is absolutely essential to significantly strengthen the capacity of border management authorities. This crucial process must involve comprehensive and highly coordinated efforts that focus on substantial institutional reform, extensive and targeted personnel training, and the proactive promotion of inter-institutional interoperability. It is of the utmost importance to recognize that fostering regional cooperation is vital within a framework that acknowledges the pressing need for a diverse, multi-layered approach to border security and management. By thoughtfully aligning available resources and strategic initiatives, it becomes increasingly possible to develop a robust and resilient system designed to effectively address the numerous complexities and challenges of border management in a challenging and dynamic context. This collaborative endeavor will not only enhance security but also greatly foster stability and peace in the region, highlighting the undeniable necessity of comprehensive planning, careful execution, and ongoing evaluation in the face of evolving threats and opportunities. (Sami and Chun, 2024)

The lack of adequate and effective management of Sudan's borders emerges as a

core and pressing threat for Sudan and its numerous neighbours. Border protection, and in particular that of areas with a history of cross-border aggression, requires a great deal of special attention. In and around the Abyei Area, the continued and troubling presence of armed groups, with certain elements based in South Sudan, represents the main and significant challenge to the territorial integrity of Sudan. Meanwhile, the Lake Albert region remains an area characterized by persistent tension, which is centred on ongoing skirmishes between the armed forces of the two countries as well as inter-communal violence that continues to disrupt peace. Yet, the insufficient management and control of Sudan's borders does not only expose the country to various risks stemming from its immediate environment; it also creates numerous opportunities for opportunistic actors to exploit these vulnerabilities, leads to criminal activities flourishing unchecked, and serves to undermine both national and regional security. In this critical context, the considerable efforts and initiatives of the African Union Border Programme (AUBP) and the Intergovernmental Authority on Development (IGAD) within the framework of the EU–Africa dialogue should be welcomed and supported. The recent establishment of an integrated nascent border management approach and the ongoing and constructive discussions between Sudan and Egypt regarding the establishment of a joint border security coordination mechanism may also yield positive developments in the near future, which could enhance the security and stability of the region overall. (Ateku and Owusu-Mensah, 2023)

5.2. Humanitarian corridors, refugee policy, and regional labor mobility

Guaranteeing humanitarian access from the neighboring countries to individuals displaced by the ongoing war in Sudan is an undeniably crucial requirement that must be addressed

with urgency. To effectively facilitate this, comprehensive security agreements need to be established without delay, clearly defining the essential corridors that will allow safe passage. This is vital for ensuring that adequate plans can be meticulously put in place for the efficient routing and delivery of humanitarian assistance. Furthermore, external agencies involved in this mission must be guaranteed safe passage and ample support for the effective delivery of humanitarian assistance as well as for the rehabilitation of the local population affected by the crisis. (Schimmel, 2022)

It is imperative that the governments of the surrounding countries actively work to attract substantial financial assistance aimed at building camps specifically designed for housing refugees and providing immediate support to both the fleeing population and the local communities that are greatly impacted by the influx of these individuals. In conjunction with the flows of humanitarian aid, a comprehensive and responsible policy towards refugees should be adopted to ensure that their rights and needs are adequately met. The fact that labor migration has historically been of significant importance in the Sudanese–Egyptian relations should be carefully considered in this context. Sudanese migrants currently represent about 5% of the Egyptian formal labor market; their contributions in terms of remittances, family reunification efforts, and the promotion of social cohesion are highly beneficial and positive for Sudanese society as a whole and should be recognized as a pivotal aspect of this ongoing narrative.

Since the onset of the devastating civil war in Sudan, more than a million refugees have fled the country in search of safety. A vast majority of these displaced individuals have sought refuge in neighboring countries, looking for any semblance of security and shelter away from the turmoil they have experienced.

Currently, the sole nation that remains open to accepting asylum-seekers fleeing the conflict in Sudan is Egypt, which has become a focal point for many desperate families and individuals. In addition to those seeking refuge abroad, there are also internally displaced persons who have been forced to relocate within Sudan. These individuals are often found in concentrated groups along major transportation routes, including significant roads and railways, that provide the best opportunities for improved safety as well as access to essential resources such as food and clean water. However, relief agencies are increasingly concerned that the prevailing environment of insecurity may contribute to the rise of trafficking networks and arms smuggling operations. Adding another layer of complexity to the situation, Eritrea has explicitly shown support for the rebel factions present in eastern Sudan and currently does not uphold control over the border shared with Sudan. These intricate border dynamics result in an escalating necessity for a comprehensive analysis of how secure the borders and frontiers with Sudan truly are, alongside a more expansive evaluation of the external integrity of Sudan's territorial claims and defenses. (Bhatt, 2022)

5.3. Inclusive governance, peace negotiations, and transitional arrangements

Inclusive, broadly supported governance in Sudan has the potential to significantly limit the systemic risk posed by the ongoing war for neighbouring states, as well as contribute to the overall stability of the larger region. Achieving this goal necessitates engaging in comprehensive negotiations that ultimately lead to peace, ensuring the establishment of ceasefires, promoting demilitarization, and creating governing arrangements that effectively address the varied security needs of both state and non-state actors. Additionally, these arrangements must facilitate the maintenance of basic law and order during a

crucial period characterized by humanitarian response and the need for reconstruction.

Considering the active involvement of the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the Sudan People's Liberation Army (SPLA) in critical battles, pursuing targeted mediation might be a prudent approach; this could entail simultaneous dialogue with the Sudanese Armed Forces and the Rapid Support Forces. Furthermore, placing an early emphasis on formulating a constitutional ushnah – which encompasses the foundational principles of future governance – is strongly recommended as a step forward. (Gabriel, 2025)

For the Sudanese Armed Forces to navigate the complexities of the current situation effectively, it will be essential to provide them with compelling internal and external options for managing warfare in the interim as well as establishing a clear political-military direction for the future. Power-sharing arrangements that incorporate the Rapid Support Forces and particularly its associated militias should be carefully designed to minimize their local appetites for power, thereby lessening the risks posed to national stability. It is equally important to integrate elements of professionalization within these forces to create a more disciplined and accountable military structure moving forward.

Thoughtful and meticulous sequencing, along with detailed time-lines and ongoing monitoring, are critically important for laying the groundwork for initial governance. Confirming a ceasefire is essential, and establishing a joint coordination centre, alongside a second designated authority specifically for Sudan, should be prioritized. In addition to these measures, creating a collaborative process dedicated to addressing humanitarian access and providing necessary assistance are significant steps that should be

not only possible but readily achievable in this context. (Brickhill et al.2025)

Conclusion

The ongoing conflict in Sudan poses immediate and long-term challenges for the security of the country itself and of its neighbors. In the short term, the risk of spillover of the violence and the associated human dislocation and humanitarian crisis are of principal concern. Two Egyptian generals, Abdel Fattah al-Sisi and Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo, commonly known as Hemedti, are vying for supremacy; the former through a formal chain of command and state-sanctioned use of force, the latter in a paramilitary manner and virtually beyond existing authority. An eventual change in the status quo in Khartoum may nonetheless embolden other territories and political entities, forcing the contenders for leadership in Cairo to recalibrate their security radar. Indeed, the joint statement on the conflict from the heads of state and government of the Inter-Governmental Authority on Development (IGAD) region listed threats to sustaining military operational regional capabilities created not by the conflict itself but by the ongoing war in Ukraine.

Concern about the prospects for the territorial integrity of Sudan has acquired new dimensions given the expansion of the conflict between the armed forces and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) beyond the confines of Khartoum. Should the Intra-Sudanese Dialogue remain on hold and the political vacuum continue, the capacity of the Sudanese armed forces to monitor and control the borders, and thus to prevent cross-border aggression and trafficking of destabilizing arms, may diminish significantly. At the same time, regions and zones along the border that were previously monitored will take on new significance as fragile territories.

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